PROJECT REPORT: Digital Literacy

Student Name: Tarun Sengar

Registration ID: 25BAI11119

Course Code/Subject: CSE0001

Introduction

Today, digital literacy is fundamental for students as the vast majority of academic and professional workflows depend on internet connectivity. Whether it is studying, submitting assignments, or applying for internships, the transition to online platforms is absolute. Consequently, mastering digital tools is no longer optional but a necessity for success.

In this project, I served as a **Student Digital Ambassador**. My primary objective was to analyze various dimensions of digital literacy and identify methods to assist peers in optimizing their use of technology. Through structured tasks, I gained proficiency in online platforms, professional communication, and cyber safety—practical knowledge essential for both my current academic journey and future professional career.

Task-1: Infographic Design

The objective of this task was to synthesize complex digital literacy concepts into a simplified, visual format. I utilized **Canva** to create an infographic aimed at making these concepts accessible to the student body.

- **Content Focus:** The infographic covered definitions of digital literacy, internet safety protocols, and the importance of maintaining a professional online presence.
- **Design Philosophy:** I prioritized a clean, "uncluttered" layout to ensure readability and engagement.
- **Challenges:** A significant hurdle was information density—managing a large volume of data on a single page without compromising the aesthetic.
- **Outcome:** By iterating through different layouts, I successfully organized the content, reinforcing how visual hierarchy can make technical learning more effective.

Task-2: Digital Portfolio Development

For Task 2, I established and refined my professional presence across three critical platforms: **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**. These act as a digital portfolio to showcase technical growth throughout my engineering degree.

- **GitHub:** Used for version control and project documentation. I configured a profile README to highlight my academic details and learning goals. It will serve as a repository for my future technical experiments and mini-projects.
- **LinkedIn:** Utilized for professional networking. This platform allows me to connect with faculty, alumni, and industry professionals while staying updated on career pathways and internship opportunities.
- **Kaggle:** Focused on data science and analytical problem-solving. I intend to use this to improve my programming skills and handle complex datasets, supporting both core CS concepts and advanced technical domains.

Task-3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

This task involved a dual focus on individual technical skill and collaborative digital tools.

- **Technical Solving:** I utilized **HackerRank** to complete beginner-level challenges (e.g., "Solve me first" and "Mini-Max Sum"), which helped strengthen my logical thinking and Python syntax.
- **Cloud Collaboration:** I developed a **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** using **Google Forms**. The integration with **Google Sheets** allowed for automated data collection and real-time analysis of the responses.
- **Key Insight:** This task demonstrated how cloud-based tools and coding platforms can be integrated to support broader academic goals.

Task-4: Professional Email Etiquette

Effective digital communication is a pillar of digital literacy. A frequent issue arises when students communicate with faculty without proper structure—such as omitting subject lines or using an informal tone (e.g., "Send the assignment deadline fast").

Such lapses can lead to:

- Professional misunderstandings.
- Delayed or ignored responses.
- Perceptions of rudeness.

Resolution: These issues are avoided by adhering to a professional protocol: a clear subject line, a formal greeting, a polite body text, and a signature including the student’s name and registration number.

Task-5: Cybercrime Awareness & Safety

Researching cybercrime revealed the surprising ease with which individuals fall victim to **phishing** and **UPI fraud**.

- **Observation:** Fraudsters often use "urgent" language—such as fake bank alerts—to induce panic and force a quick, unverified response.
- **Behavioral Change:** As a direct result of this task, I am implementing a "Verification First" habit. I will no longer click unverified links, will check URLs for authenticity, and have enabled **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all critical accounts to ensure robust security.

Conclusion

This project provided a practical framework for digital engagement that moved beyond theoretical understanding. By actively using these tools, I have gained significant confidence in navigating digital platforms and communicating professionally. As a Digital Ambassador, I am now equipped to share these best practices with my peers, fostering a safer and more efficient digital environment for our community.

References

- **Design Tool:** Canva
- **Version Control:** GitHub
- **Networking:** LinkedIn
- **Data Science:** Kaggle
- **Coding Practice:** HackerRank
- **Collaboration:** Google Forms
- **Case Study:** *Bhopal cyber fraudster steals Rs 97,129*, Times of India. Link